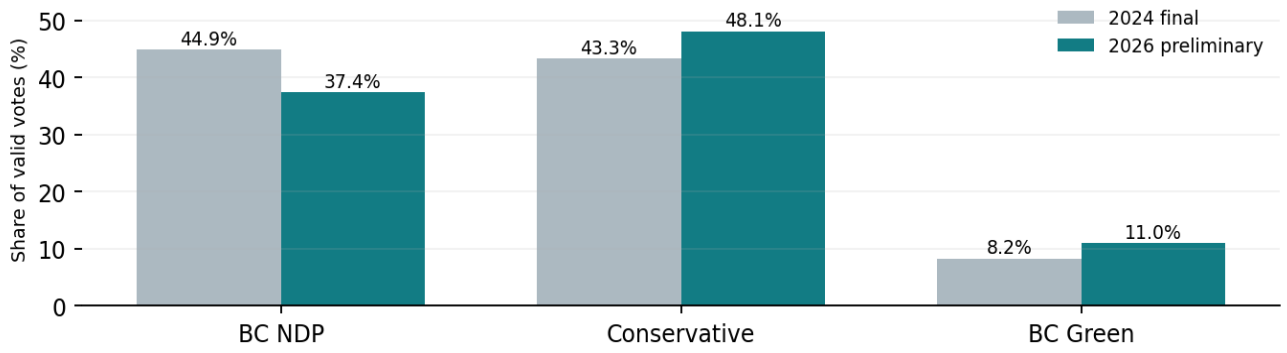
BC Provincial Election 2026

Initial-count debrief: October 26, 2026, 10:34 a.m. PDT This report compares the preliminary 2026 Elections BC count with its certified 2024 results for all 93 ridings.

Indicator	2024 certified	2026 initial	Change
BC NDP vote share	44.87%	37.37%	-7.50 pp
Conservative vote share	43.28%	48.06%	+4.78 pp
BC Green vote share	8.24%	10.97%	+2.73 pp
NDP ridings won / leading	47	28	−19 net
Ballots cast / considered	2,109,658	1,799,550	-14.7% (provisional)
Participation (province)	58.45%	48.14%	−10.31 pp (provisional)



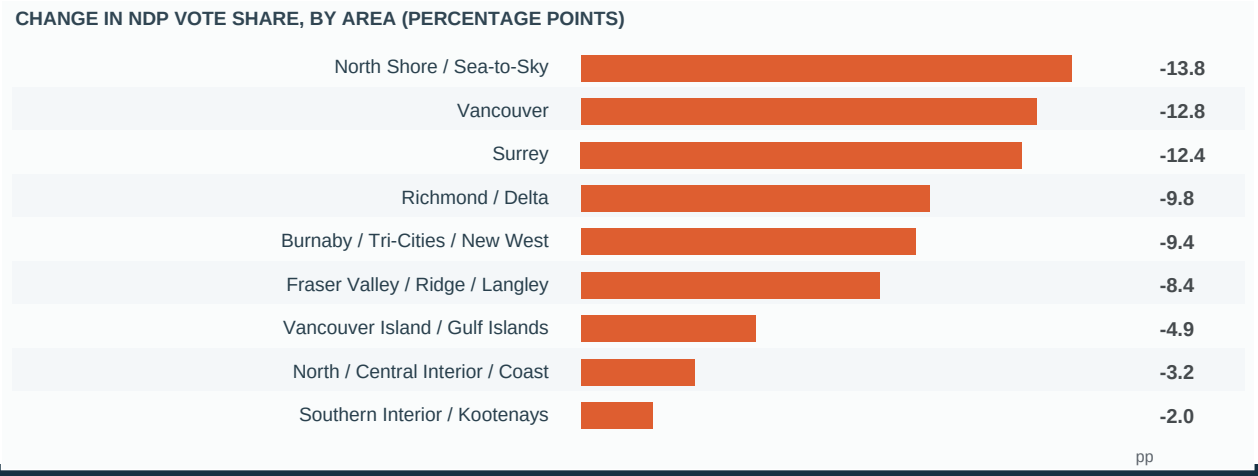
Three statements supported by the results

- The NDP lost vote share broadly: 83 of 93 ridings record a fall in NDP share; 20 previously NDP-leading ridings now have other parties ahead, partly offset by Courtenay–Comox.
- The geographic decline is uneven: it is sharpest in North Shore/Sea-to-Sky, Vancouver and Surrey on weighted regional calculations; it is smaller in parts of the Interior.
- Participation is a central but unresolved issue: all 93 ridings have fewer ballots included than in 2024. The province-wide 48.14% figure is provisional and omits outstanding ballot categories.

Interpretation limit: A party-share change is not evidence that particular voters switched parties. Green candidate coverage, local contests, turnout and additional parties may all matter.

1 | The geography of the decline

Regions below are custom analytical groupings, weighted by each election's valid votes—not simple averages of riding swings. They are not Elections BC's administrative regions.



Analytical area	Ridings	NDP '24	NDP '26	Δ pp	NDP leads '24→'26
North Shore / Sea-to-Sky	4	43.0%	29.2%	-13.8	2 → 1
Vancouver	12	58.3%	45.5%	-12.8	11 → 8
Surrey	10	46.2%	33.8%	-12.4	4 → 0
Richmond / Delta	6	43.5%	33.7%	-9.8	2 → 0
Burnaby / Tri-Cities / New West	10	53.9%	44.4%	-9.4	10 → 5
Fraser Valley / Ridge / Langley	10	42.8%	34.3%	-8.4	1 → 0
Vancouver Island / Gulf Islands	15	46.0%	41.0%	-4.9	12 → 10
North / Central Interior / Coast	11	28.7%	25.4%	-3.2	1 → 1
Southern Interior / Kootenays / Coast	15	38.2%	36.2%	-2.0	4 → 3

What to discuss

- Surrey had four NDP leads in 2024 and none in the initial 2026 count; Vancouver declined from 11 to eight.
- The NDP has maintained a lead in several Vancouver Island ridings, but also lost Cowichan Valley, Juan de Fuca–Malahat and Saanich South.
- In all regions, a smaller number of counted ballots may compound the significance of shifts in party preference. The two cannot be decomposed without further voter-level information.

2 | Seats that changed political lead

20 riding leads lost by the BC NDP and one gained, comparing winners in 2024 with the 2026 initial-count leaders. Final count can change close races. Entries below are sorted by the change in NDP share.

Riding	NDP 2024	NDP 2026	Share shift	Leader now	Margin
Vancouver-Fraserview	57.2%	41.7%	-15.5 pp	Conservative	387
Burnaby Centre	57.3%	41.9%	-15.4 pp	Conservative	780
North Vancouver-Seymour	52.8%	37.4%	-15.3 pp	Conservative	2,466
Saanich South	49.8%	34.7%	-15.0 pp	Conservative	1,227
Delta North	52.7%	40.6%	-12.1 pp	Conservative	2,371
Coquitlam-Burke Mountain	50.8%	39.3%	-11.6 pp	Conservative	2,491
Burnaby North	53.3%	42.1%	-11.2 pp	Conservative	782
Surrey-Fleetwood	48.6%	38.1%	-10.5 pp	Conservative	2,169
Surrey-Newton	51.2%	40.7%	-10.5 pp	Conservative	1,858
Maple Ridge-Pitt Meadows	54.9%	44.5%	-10.3 pp	Conservative	850
Coquitlam-Maillardville	51.8%	41.5%	-10.3 pp	Conservative	1,569
Port Moody-Burquitlam	52.1%	42.1%	-9.9 pp	Conservative	1,078
Vancouver-Langara	48.4%	39.0%	-9.5 pp	Conservative	1,650
Richmond-Steveston	44.3%	35.0%	-9.3 pp	Conservative	3,841
Vancouver-Yaletown	49.8%	41.0%	-8.8 pp	Conservative	844
Surrey-Guildford	46.9%	41.0%	-5.9 pp	Conservative	1,472
Vernon-Lumby	42.7%	37.8%	-4.9 pp	Conservative	3,254
Surrey City Centre	46.7%	44.2%	-2.5 pp	Conservative	395
Juan de Fuca-Malahat	38.8%	38.2%	-0.6 pp	Conservative	768
Cowichan Valley	40.5%	42.3%	+1.8 pp	Conservative	151

NDP gain: Courtenay–Comox moved from a Conservative lead (2024) to an NDP lead (2026), by 696 votes and with NDP share up +6.5 pp.

Context: Cowichan Valley illustrates why a seat can flip even with an increased NDP share: the Conservatives gained enough relative support to take the lead.

3 | Greens, candidate choice & fragmentation

BC Green vote share rose from 8.24% to 10.97% provincially. The Greens lead in two ridings, the same count as their 2024 seats. Local patterns nevertheless differ sharply.

Largest Green gains where Greens contested both elections

Riding	Green 2024	Green 2026	Green Δ pp	NDP Δ pp
Vancouver-Strathcona	13.1%	29.0%	+15.9 pp	-13.1 pp
Saanich North and the Islands	36.2%	48.5%	+12.3 pp	-14.7 pp
Victoria-Swan Lake	23.2%	35.2%	+12.1 pp	-12.4 pp
Vancouver-Kensington	7.6%	17.4%	+9.8 pp	-14.2 pp
West Vancouver-Sea to Sky	38.1%	47.6%	+9.5 pp	-16.0 pp
Vancouver-Little Mountain	7.3%	16.6%	+9.3 pp	-13.0 pp
Vancouver-West End	9.1%	17.9%	+8.8 pp	-11.4 pp
Saanich South	17.8%	26.0%	+8.2 pp	-15.0 pp
Vancouver-South Granville	10.7%	18.9%	+8.1 pp	-16.9 pp
Vancouver-Hastings	10.9%	18.9%	+8.0 pp	-12.9 pp
Vancouver-Fraserview	6.2%	14.2%	+8.0 pp	-15.5 pp
Victoria-Beacon Hill	33.5%	40.3%	+6.8 pp	-1.7 pp

Noteworthy differences in party coverage

- The Greens contested 69 ridings in 2024 and 73 in 2026. Comparisons must identify ridings without a candidate in one year.
- The 2026 “Other” grouping includes CentreBC, OneBC and smaller parties or independent candidates; its composition differs from 2024. “Other” is not a single party.
- NDP did not field a candidate in Peace River North in 2026; this is marked in the workbook. A zero NDP share here reflects ballot choice, not solely voter support.
- 2026 Greens lead in Saanich North and the Islands and West Vancouver–Sea to Sky. These areas warrant separate local-context analysis.

Avoid ecological inference: Where NDP share falls and Green share rises, the data are consistent with multiple stories—vote switching, non-voting, changed candidates, and new voters. They cannot establish which occurred.

4 | Races to watch at final count

The following preliminary margins are the gap between the two leading candidates or groups in each riding (all ballot boxes reporting, but mail-in and absentee counting outstanding).

#	Riding	Leader	Margin	NDP Δ pp
1	Ladysmith-Oceanside	NDP	13	+2.9 pp
2	Burnaby South-Metrotown	NDP	66	-4.9 pp
3	Kelowna Centre	Conservative	132	+5.1 pp
4	Cowichan Valley	Conservative	151	+1.8 pp
5	Burnaby East	NDP	241	-7.4 pp
6	Port Coquitlam	NDP	386	-8.5 pp
7	Vancouver-Fraserview	Conservative	387	-15.5 pp
8	Surrey City Centre	Conservative	395	-2.5 pp
9	Bulkley Valley-Stikine	Conservative	461	+6.7 pp
10	Kootenay Central	NDP	467	-0.1 pp
11	Vancouver-Point Grey	NDP	538	-13.8 pp
12	Courtenay-Comox	NDP	696	+6.5 pp
13	Juan de Fuca-Malahat	Conservative	768	-0.6 pp
14	Burnaby Centre	Conservative	780	-15.4 pp

Limitations and next steps

- Preliminary means preliminary: all 2026 polling-place boxes are reported, not all eligible ballots counted. Final count is planned for November 6–10, 2026.
- Turnout comparison: the 2024 registered-voter total is as of election close, while 2026 currently references the October 14 register. This PDF does not calculate 2026 district turnout rates.
- Missing explanatory variables: no evidence here by age, identity, campaign contact, issue salience or past vote; do not infer individual voter motivations.
- Final revision: replace district votes after Elections BC certifies 2026, reconcile both party and ballot totals, add district-level registered-voter data if published, then revise close-race outcomes and interpretation.

Official sources

Elections BC 2026 initial-count results: results.elections.bc.ca (snapshot 26 October 2026, 10:34 PDT.

Elections BC 2024 Statement of Votes, 43rd Provincial General Election: elections.bc.ca/docs/rpt/statement-of-votes-2024-provincial-election.pdf, pages 13–15 summary by riding.